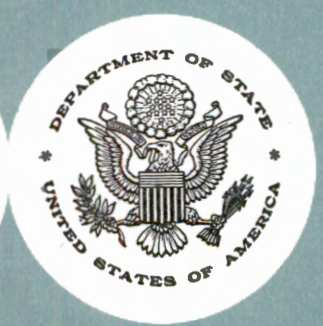
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# The Department of State bulletin

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# The United States and a Divided China

*by Alfred leSesne Jenkins*

Until the Chinese mainland came under Communist domination in 1949, the United States had enjoyed more than a century and a half of friendship with the Chinese people, during which our contacts with China—commercial, cultural, religious, and political—were extensive. Our record in standing for the political independence and territorial integrity of China is a well-known one, and the Second World War found our two peoples comrades-in-arms against the imperialistic power of that period which sought to destroy us. The subsequent subjugation of the Chinese mainland to the alien domination of yet another imperialism is not only a cause of deep regret to us because it has severed our traditionally close relations with the vast majority of the Chinese people; it is also a cause of the greatest concern to us, in that a hostile and aggressive China, in collusion with the Soviet Union and its European satellites, vastly enhances the threat of Communist imperialism to our own peace and security and to that of the entire free world.

The oft-confessed objective of Communist imperialism is nothing less than world domination. The Soviet leaders must be well aware that this can never be accomplished with any semblance of legitimacy. Not one national group of the 800 million souls now under Communist rule has ever voted itself into communism. The free world has shown a perverse disinclination to be "liberated" from its free institutions and way of life. Communist successes for the past 37 years have been the result of following Lenin's exhortation to resort to every form of "ruses, dodges, tricks, cunning, unlawful methods, concealments and veilings of the truth." Communist tactics have included, in various combinations, infiltration, subversion and sabotage, "united fronts" with other parties while control of army and police is secured, partition of countries which cannot at the time be won in toto, and, when the time seems ripe, coups d'etat or civil war. Communist conquest has by no means, therefore, been confined to bald military aggression, although this more conventional method of imperialistic aggrandizement has not been spurned when the odds appeared to be overwhelmingly in the Communists' favor.

This pattern of Communist conquest has become sickeningly familiar since World War II. Its methodology, insidious, resilient, and multiform as it is, is not easy to combat, but it can be done. The rapid growth of Communist parties in Western Europe immediately after the war has at least been stopped in its tracks. Western Europe, alarmed and awakened chiefly by the fate of Poland and Czechoslovakia, demonstrated its determination to regain its strength promptly and to remain vigilant. Communist imperialism, thwarted in the West by European acceptance of the Marshall plan, the creation of NATO, and the prospect of a European Defense Community, and in the South by the failure of its designs against Greece, Turkey, and Iran, turned its attention to the East, where the first of the three great Asian prizes had all but dropped into its lap.

### What the Communists Want in Asia

Both the world Communist conspiracy and Soviet imperialism, to the degree that the two may be distinguished, want of Asia three things. First, communism needs the manpower of China, which constitutes one-fourth of the world's total population. This it now has, except for the Free Chinese on Formosa. Second, it needs the industrial capacity of Japan. This was the ultimate goal in its ill-fated Korean adventure. Third, it needs the surplus food and rich mineral resources of Southeast Asia. Presently threatened Indochina is the gateway to this wealth and contains a good portion of it. This characterization of the three great Asian prizes eyed by Communist imperialism is something of an oversimplification, of course. China, for instance, brings to the Communist fold a good deal more than just manpower, valuable as that is and freely as it was squandered in Korea. The important thing to remember is that the Communist rulers have every intention of using their first great Asian prize as the primary means of attaining the second and third. And the Chinese Communists, for their

part, appear to be close and willing accomplices in this plot, expecting to gain much for themselves as junior partners in the Sino-Soviet alliance. It is also important to remember that the Chinese Communists are thoroughly schooled in the same tradition as their Soviet mentors. The Chinese have proved to be apt pupils and have even added a few twists of their own to the Soviet legacy, both in their internal and external conduct. Communist China's imperialistic adventures in both Korea and in Indochina, although not the same in form, have both followed orthodox Communist patterns.

The best hope of communism is in a situation where it can deal separately and individually with its intended victims. Its spread was halted in Europe only when this became impossible. The Communist attempt to swallow the whole of Korea failed because of united action of a kind unique in history, but Korea remains divided. The Communists so far have been able to concentrate their attention in turn upon Indochina without the deterrent of that collective security which must yet be devised for Free Asia if it is not to be enslaved in the Communist fashion, piecemeal.

Issues of incalculable import are in the balance in Asia at this time. I have dwelt initially upon aspects somewhat broader than our immediate subject in order to set the perspective for the role Communist China has been allotted to play, and indeed is playing, in the world Communist program of conquest. It has been given primary responsibility for the communization of the rest of Asia but has recognized the leadership of the Soviet Union for the whole of the Communist camp.

Since April 26 our representatives have been in Geneva to discuss the two most serious sources of tension in the Far East, the danger spots of Korea and Indochina. In both instances it is primarily Communist China, with the full support of the Soviet Union, which has thus endangered the peace of the world. We are participating in the Conference at Geneva with the sincere purpose of seeking a settlement of these two great Asian problems. We still hope that at least some progress toward reducing tensions in the Far East may be possible. We are, however, keenly aware of the Communists' record of bad faith. We are especially mindful of the Chinese Communists' wonted use of the conference table as a means of waging war by carefully timed cease-fire, a tactic used by them to great advantage in the Chinese civil war. During the cease-fire in Korea, by means of a deliberate and systematic circumvention of the Armistice Agreement, the Communists have engaged in a significant military build-up in North Korea. It would be fatuous to agree at Geneva to a cease-fire in Indochina without adequate safeguards against this all-too-familiar Communist tactic.

Whatever the Communist intent with respect to Korean and Indochinese settlements, they have stridently demanded that the convicted aggressor whose acts have chiefly made the conference necessary be accorded international acceptance and so-called big-power status in this conference. We and our allies refused to yield to these demands and to convene a so-called five-power conference to deal with world problems, for which the Communists were so anxious. Communist China is necessarily at the conference, since it is deeply involved in both questions to be considered. Communist China obviously wants to achieve, partly by means of this conference itself, general diplomatic recognition by the family of nations, a seat in the United Nations, and a relaxation of trade restrictions.

#### Nature of Chinese Communist Regime

What is the nature of this regime which unashamedly demands international acceptance at a conference called to deal urgently with problems chiefly of that regime's own creation? It came to power by force of arms and with full moral, and limited material, support of an alien power which even at that time was bound by a treaty of friendship and alliance with the Chinese Government under President Chiang Kai-shek. It came to power by the familiar "united front" tactics, discarded as soon as police state controls made it possible. We do not believe that it represents the will of the people it governs. It has acted on no recognizable standards of international conduct. It has repeatedly expressed contempt for the purposes and principles of the United Nations and still stands convicted by that body as an aggressor in Korea. Its aggressive record in Korea, Indochina, and Tibet and its relentless program of infiltration and subversion in other Asian countries make it a serious threat to all the free peoples of Asia.

By stepping up the fighting in Indochina in an obvious attempt to influence the outcome of the Geneva Conference the Communists have shown the same callous disregard for the extravagant expenditure of Viet Minh lives as they showed for Chinese lives in Korea. The Chinese Communist regime disregarded the most elemental rules of prisoner-of-war treatment in Korea, committing unspeakable atrocities against United Nations troops. It has carried on a methodical "Hate America" campaign among its own people and has subjected American and other foreign nationals to all manner of indignity, has confiscated foreign property without compensation, and has often made it impossible for foreign business establishments either to carry on or to close down. It still holds 32 American civilians in prison, incommunicado, under intolerable physical conditions, without trial and without even a statement of charges. It has developed "brain

washing" to a fine science to secure useful, if false, confessions from prisoners and has even directed it against its own nationals to secure in recalcitrant cases the complete obedience and conformity which must characterize the "new socialist man." The regime has liquidated millions of its own citizens, by means ranging from outright murder to induced suicide, in its attacks on private businessmen and in the spurious land reform program which brought it early support from the unsuspecting peasants but which is now, as control of the land is taken over by the state, bringing it the mute and impotent hostility of the dispossessed farmers. There is not only no freedom of speech, press, or assembly; there is not even freedom of silence, since all must be vocal in their support of Communist policies.

The regime has set about painstakingly to change the whole fabric of traditional Chinese society. Through endless study groups it has attempted to reach every citizen, in the attempt to make his thoughts and acts conform to the supposed needs of the Party. These study groups involve lectures by Communist cadres, the reading of prescribed texts, and "discussion." The lectures invariably contain the "right" answers to the problem at hand, but hours and often even weeks are then spent in endless discussions which are preordained to end up right where they started: with the "right" answers. No segment of the population is excluded from the Communist program of remolding the individual. The soldier is given special attention, in this as in other matters. I have talked in Chinese with country boys in the Chinese Communist Army who could scarcely phrase a compound sentence on most subjects but who could hold forth by the hour with astounding facility on the subjects of dialectical materialism and the history of Western imperialism, Communist version.

Even the so-called educational institutions do not escape the heavy imprint of the political requirements regarded as the current specific for the ailments of the Communist state. Academic research, like religion, the economy, and the patterns of social behavior, is made the handmaiden of the Communist brand of politics. The family unit is a special target of the Communists. Children are trained to spy and report on their parents, and they not infrequently have denounced their parents in instances where they knew it meant the death of their parents. Finally, the regime, in order to gain sorely needed foreign exchange, has stooped to trade in narcotics and to blackmail of overseas Chinese whose relatives on the mainland are at its mercy.

In short, the Mao Tse-tung regime, whose cause is pled at Geneva by Chou En-lai, internally is a police state of the worst order and externally is a convicted aggressor, a continuing threat to its neighbors, and apparently an enemy of all nations who do not choose to identify themselves completely with the camp of "peace-loving nations under the leadership of the Soviet Union." It is the Communists who insist that there is no third, middle, or neutral road. All who are not for them are considered to be against them. At least there can be no doubt as to where Communist China stands, and there should be no room left for wishful thinking on the subject. Mao Tse-tung, upon the inception of his regime on October 1, 1949, proclaimed his so-called "lean to one side policy," that is, toward the Soviet side. This bids fair to be the understatement of our time. Mao was less reserved when, upon the death of Stalin, he sent a telegram to Moscow declaring that Red China would stand by the Soviet Union "definitely, forever and with maximum resoluteness." This smacks more of prostration than of leaning.

Communist China, it is true, is not in the same impotent situation in the Communist orbit as are the Eastern European satellites. The very size, geographical location, and importance of China assure it a special status. We cannot read into this situation any significant element of divisiveness, however. The very fact of special status doubtless makes Communist China more comfortable in the Soviet camp than it would otherwise be. In time there may well be increasing frictions between the Chinese and Russians. Russia has traditionally had aggressive designs against China. Difficulties may well mount in time over Soviet influence in China's Northeast and Northwest, over control of the Communist movement in the rest of Asia, over Chinese disappointment at the limitations of Soviet aid commitments, and perhaps over alleged ideological heresies. For the foreseeable future, however, the affinities which bind the two powers together are likely to be much stronger than the divisive frictions.

Such is the nature of the regime which appears at Geneva to be making a bid for general recognition, for entry into the United Nations, and for freer trade with the West. The United States, for its part, cannot recognize this regime. We will continue vigorously to oppose its admission to any United Nations body as the representative of the Chinese people. And we cannot favor a relaxation of trade controls justly imposed against a convicted aggressor which has given no indication of having altered its aggressive course but on the contrary remains a constant threat to its neighbors and desires to build up its industrial base to support a war machine with the avowed purpose of "liberating" the rest of the world. We believe that to do so would, on the one hand, further confirm the Chinese Communists in their dedication to their present loyalties and courses of action and, on the other, tend to produce disillusionment and discouragement on the part of other Asian nations anxious to maintain their freedom and in many instances their newly won independence.

**Continuing Recognition of Free China**

There is another reason why we cannot accept the Peiping regime as representative of the Chinese people. We have no intention of turning our backs on the Republic of China on Formosa or of forsaking the 10 million Free Chinese on that Island to a fate of Communist tyranny. We believe that the Republic of China is far more representative of the will of the Chinese people than is the regime on the mainland. It continues to represent China in the United Nations ably, responsibly, and with dignity.

It is highly important that at this juncture, when attention is focused upon the Chinese Communist regime, primarily because of its outrageous conduct, we not forget the real and potential importance of the cause of Free China. There is abundant precedent for the free nations' continued recognition even of governments in exile, for considerations dictated by reason and principle, when those governments retain no territorial control or military potential. Free China, however, is a going and growing concern, which is developing in increasingly favorable contrast to the conditions of tyranny and oppression imposed on the mainland by its would-be successor regime. That it has yet failed fully to achieve, by its own ready admission, that standard of democratic excellence by which it is often judged is hardly surprising, considering the facts that it has had only 6 years of constitutional government, is in a period of acute national emergency, and with extremely limited national resources is called upon to support a disproportionately large military establishment and maintain the morale and loyalty of civil servants on a below-subsistence level of pay. Even with outside aid this is a large order. The surprising thing is that the Island is as stable as it is, that the economy, with its several weaknesses, is as strong as it is, that its military potential grows as it does, that morale both among the military and the civilian population is as high as it is, that the Island is as free from subversion as it is, and that in these troublous times there is as much freedom of the press, speech, and person as there is. I have lived in both Communist China and Free China, and I am unable to view the appellation "Free China" as any misnomer. It is deserving of free world support.

The United States will continue its military, economic, and political support of the Government of the Republic of China, and we will continue to support it as the representative of China in the United Nations. The Chinese Communists, in their extravagant propaganda, continue to speak of our "forceful occupation" of Formosa. This is preposterous, as all the world knows. Our advisers and technicians are there at the express invitation of the Government of China, to help it maintain its economic and political stability and to assist the Chinese to develop and maintain a military establishment capable of defending the Island from Communist invasion and to make a greater contribution as an important part of the anti-Communist armed might in opposition to Communist aggression and expansion in the Pacific.

Such, in brief, is the problem and the promise presented to us by a divided China at this hour of grave crisis in Asian and world history. To meet this hour at Geneva and elsewhere with the degree of sober responsibility for which all men who treasure freedom look, requires all the resoluteness, faith, wisdom, firmness, patience, and understanding which we can summon. It would be idle at this point to speculate upon the outcome of the important conference now being held at Geneva. The next few days may be decisive. But there can be little doubt that the issues with which we are concerned at Geneva provide another severe test of the very principle of collective security on which may rest the fate of hundreds of millions of Asians, and ultimately of us all.

● *Mr. Jenkins, author of the above article, is Officer in Charge of Political Affairs, Office of Chinese Affairs. His article is based on an address made before the Scarlet Key Honor Society of Boston University, Boston, Mass., on May 5.*

## U. S. Policy on Participation in Collective Defense

Press release 284 dated May 25

*At his news conference on May 25, a correspondent recalled to Secretary Dulles his report to the Nation following his return from Geneva[1] in which he set forth the conditions under which the United States intervened in Korea. Mr. Dulles was asked to relate those conditions to the Indochina situation. Mr. Dulles made the following reply:*

I pointed out, I think, the existence of certain conditions in the case of Korea, and I went on to say that the situation in Indochina was different and more complex.

I think that broadly speaking the attitude of the United States toward this situation has been made clear by statements which the President has made and which I have made. I think it is fair to say that the United States attitude in this matter has been one of the few stable aspects in an otherwise changing and fluid situation.

The position of the United States toward collective security in Southeast Asia has been known basically for quite a long while. In fact, it really goes back to the time when I went out to the Far East in, I think, January of 1951 on a mission to

[1] Bulletin of May 17, 1954, p. 739.